

GovGazette UI/UX Design Brief

Product vision, interaction
principles, core journeys
and design-system direction.

DESIGN FOR TRUST / DESIGN FOR ACTION

EVIDENCE-FIRST / HUMAN-CENTRED

Design a procurement product that feels clear, credible and operational

GovGazette should make a complicated procurement process feel understandable, trustworthy and manageable - not simply make a tender portal look more modern.

The product in one sentence

GovGazette is the procurement operating system for companies that sell to government: discover the right opportunities, understand the requirements, assess readiness, prepare a compliant response and learn from outcomes.

01 Discover

Find relevant procurement opportunities across fragmented sources.

03 Match

Explain whether a specific company is eligible and well positioned.

05 Respond

Coordinate compliance, drafting, review, approval and submission.

02 Understand

Turn tender documents into clear requirements, dates and obligations.

04 Qualify

Show readiness, unresolved risk and evidence gaps before a pursuit begins.

06 Learn

Use outcomes and history to improve future opportunity decisions.

Three UX questions to keep visible

What should I care about? What do I need to do next? Can I trust how GovGazette reached this conclusion?

The interface should remove friction, not reproduce it

Procurement teams already work across portals, PDFs, spreadsheets, email, shared drives and old proposals. The product experience should consolidate that complexity into a guided operating workflow.

Typical friction today

- Opportunities are scattered across procurement portals, government websites, gazettes, PDFs, email and agency sites.
- Long tender documents are read manually and copied into ad-hoc spreadsheets and checklists.
- Compliance evidence lives in folders and inboxes, with expiry and readiness difficult to understand.
- Bid/no-bid decisions are often late and based on incomplete information.
- Response preparation depends heavily on old proposals and institutional knowledge held by a small number of people.

Design objectives

Intelligent

The product analyses and explains information rather than merely listing records.

Trustworthy

Important conclusions expose evidence, source and review paths.

Premium

Appropriate for SMEs, professional bid teams and executive users.

Calm

Use hierarchy and progressive disclosure to reduce cognitive load.

Operational

Insights naturally lead to an action, owner, status or deadline.

Modern but serious

Avoid generic AI-SaaS visuals and government-portal aesthetics.

DISCOVER -> UNDERSTAND -> MATCH -> QUALIFY -> PREPARE -> SUBMIT -> LEARN

Design for different levels of procurement responsibility

The Bid Manager is the primary power user, but the product must remain legible to executives, administrators, contributors and reviewers without presenting each role with the same density of information.

Company Owner / Executive

Pipeline value, major deadlines, readiness gaps and procurement performance - summary before detail.

Company Administrator

Maintain organization profile, evidence, certificates, users and access.

Reviewer / Approver

See changes, evidence, unresolved risk and approve/reject controlled outputs.

Bid Manager

Qualify opportunities, create pursuits, coordinate requirements, evidence, tasks and responses.

Contributor

Work from assigned tasks, evidence requests and response sections.

Platform / Source Admin

Configure sources, taxonomy and operations while tenant content remains constrained and audited.

Proposed navigation model

Area	Primary destinations
Discover	Opportunities · Saved Searches · Watchlist · Alerts
Pipeline	Matches · Pursuits · Deadlines
Company	Profile · Capabilities · Experience · People · Certifications · Compliance · Evidence
Workspaces	Active Tenders
Intelligence	Buyers · Categories · Awards · Market Insights
Administration	Team · Organization · Notifications · Settings

Shell principle

Use persistent left navigation with lightweight top utilities for global search, notifications, organization switching and user profile. Avoid modal-heavy extended workflows; preserve context with split views, drawers and in-place detail panels.

Search and opportunity discovery should feel like intelligence, not a notice board

The discovery experience should help a company identify the few opportunities that deserve attention, while still supporting dense scanning, exact tender references and powerful filters.

Global search should understand natural intent

Example searches

hospital software tenders · ICT opportunities above P5 million · tenders closing next month · cybersecurity services in Botswana

Result information hierarchy

Tender identity

Title, procuring entity, reference, type and source.

Commercial context

Location, estimated/value information when available, category and jurisdiction.

Timing

Publication, clarification, site-visit and closing dates.

Decision support

Match score, eligibility, key strengths, key risks and next action.

Explore two complementary result modes

Mode	Purpose
List mode	Rapid scanning, sorting, filtering and comparison across many opportunities.
Intelligence card mode	Recommended opportunities with an explanation of fit, deadline and material risk.

Non-negotiable

A match percentage must never appear without an explanation of eligibility, supporting factors, weaknesses and unknowns.

Every conclusion should lead back to the source

The opportunity page must answer three questions immediately: What is this? Should we pursue it? What does it require? Provenance is part of the interaction model, not an audit feature hidden elsewhere.

Recommended information model

Surface	Content
Opportunity header	Tender title · buyer · reference · lifecycle · closing date · jurisdiction
Primary tabs	Overview · Requirements · Evaluation · Documents · Amendments · Company Match
Intelligence panel	Why this matches · strengths · risks · missing evidence · next actions
Source actions	View tender document · jump to cited page/section · compare amendment

Signature provenance interaction

Requirement example

“Bidder must demonstrate at least three comparable implementations.” Source: Tender Document · Page 63 · Section 7.4.2 [View source]

Preferred interaction: open a split view with the original PDF/document on the left and the extracted requirement or fact on the right. Highlight the exact passage and show type, mandatory/optional status, confidence and review state.

Source side

Original document, page/section context, highlighted passage and version.

Interpretation side

Structured requirement, classification, status, confidence, evidence links and review controls.

Trust rule

Evidence should always be reachable from material requirements, extracted facts, match explanations and later AI-generated claims.

Design the company profile as a body of credible claims

The company profile is not a registration form. It is the structured, evidence-backed representation of what the organization can legitimately claim when pursuing a tender.

Profile domains

Identity Legal name, registration details, addresses and organization information.	Capabilities Industries, products, services and technical competencies.
Certifications & licences ISO, procurement registration, professional and statutory credentials.	People CVs, qualifications, certifications, roles and availability.
Experience Projects, clients, dates, values, scope and references.	Financial & policies Approved financial facts, quality/security/HSE policies and methodologies.

Evidence library should show procurement readiness

Evidence	Validity	Health	Design emphasis
Tax Clearance	31 Dec 2026	HEALTHY	Valid and reusable
ISO 27001	12 Mar 2028	HEALTHY	Evidence-backed certification
Procurement Registration	23 days	EXPIRING	Needs action
Audited Financials 2025	No expiry	CURRENT	Reusable evidence

Design rule

Do not make the evidence library a Google Drive clone. Status, validity, expiry, trust and linkage to company facts are more important than folders.

Explain the score before asking users to trust it

Matching is a signature GovGazette interaction. The interface should make mandatory eligibility, capability fit, evidence readiness and uncertainty understandable at a glance.

Example summary

92% MATCH · ELIGIBLE · Strong capability fit · 4 relevant projects · Tax clearance expires before submission

Factor	Illustrative result	What the UI should expose
Eligibility	PASS	Hard conditions and any UNKNOWN state
Capability fit	96%	Relevant services/capabilities and tender passages
Experience	91%	Comparable projects and evidence
Personnel	89%	Required roles, qualifications and gaps
Compliance	94%	Available, expiring and missing evidence
Financial / scale	86%	Verified financial facts vs explicit requirements
Deadline readiness	82%	Time remaining and unresolved blockers

Match explanation should contain

- Overall score and hard eligibility status.
- Top factors increasing the score and top weaknesses reducing confidence.
- Missing or expiring evidence.
- Specific tender passages that drove requirements.
- Company facts used in the comparison.
- Recommended next actions.

UX priority

Explainability should dominate over the raw number. Unknown evidence must look different from a pass or a failure.

Show what can stop the bid, not just a percentage complete

Readiness must distinguish ordinary incomplete work from a requirement that will make the company ineligible or prevent a compliant submission.

State	Meaning
SATISFIED	Valid evidence supports the requirement.
PARTIALLY SATISFIED	Some required evidence or subconditions remain.
MISSING	No suitable evidence is available.
EXPIRED	Evidence exists but is not valid for the relevant deadline.
NOT APPLICABLE	Recorded rationale confirms the requirement does not apply.
UNKNOWN	The system cannot safely determine the answer; review is required.
FAILED	A deterministic mandatory condition is not met.

Requirements matrix

The matrix should retain spreadsheet-like scanning efficiency while making deeper interpretation available on demand. Each row needs requirement, class, status, evidence, owner and source.

Open a requirement to see

Exact tender wording · interpretation · source page/section · mandatory/optional · evidence · owner · status · notes · review history

Readiness visualization

Summary

Counts for satisfied, partial, missing, expiring, unknown and failed.

Action

Owner, due date and recommended remediation.

Priority

Blocking gaps separated from ordinary incomplete work.

Evidence

Current evidence plus validity at the tender closing date.

Make active bids feel like a control room

The pursuit workspace will become the operational heart of GovGazette. It should orient the team around readiness, deadlines, ownership and controlled progress rather than resemble a generic project board.

Workspace navigation

Overview · Requirements · Compliance · Evidence · Tasks · Clarifications · Response · Review · Submission

Workspace header

Tender identity

Title, buyer, reference and pursued document version.

Lifecycle

Qualifying, planning, drafting, review, approval, ready or submitted.

Readiness

Overall status plus blocking compliance risks.

Deadline

Closing date, days remaining and internal milestone state.

Module summaries

Module	Example summary
Requirements	43 / 57 satisfied
Compliance	81% ready · 2 blocking gaps
Tasks	12 open · 3 overdue
Response	68% complete · 4 sections in review
Documents	24 evidence/tender files
Team	7 active contributors
Clarifications	3 open items

Deadline behaviour

Communicate closing date, clarification deadline, site visit, pre-bid meeting, evidence expiry, internal review, approval and packaging without making the whole product permanently red.

AI should appear where the work is, not as a chatbot bolted onto the side

GovGazette AI is contextual assistance grounded in tender evidence, approved company facts and controlled expert guidance. The user must be able to understand what informed an answer or draft.

Good contextual entry points

Summarize

Summarize this tender or amendment.

Explain

Explain why this opportunity matches the company.

Draft

Draft this response section using approved evidence.

Extract

Identify requirements, dates or evaluation criteria.

Compare

Compare this tender requirement with our evidence.

Validate

Check this claim or section against supporting evidence.

AI evidence panel

AI trust contract

Show the tender evidence, company evidence and/or expert guidance used to produce the result. Unsupported claims must be visible as unsupported, not silently polished.

Visual language

- Use subtle purple or multicolour accents for AI-assisted functionality.
- Avoid robots, glowing “magic” interfaces and excessive sparkle iconography.
- Communicate assisted intelligence, not autonomous authority.
- Make correction, confirmation, source review and human approval obvious where decisions matter.

Prioritize attention and progressive value

The landing page should tell users what deserves attention now. Onboarding should improve the company profile progressively rather than block value behind a long setup wizard.

Dashboard content hierarchy

Attention Strong matches, tenders closing soon, expiring evidence and items awaiting review.	Recommended opportunities Three to five high-value recommendations with reasons.
Active pursuits Readiness, deadline, blockers and progress.	Company readiness Capability and evidence gaps that restrict future bids.

Progressive onboarding

COMPANY -> CAPABILITIES -> CERTIFICATIONS -> EXPERIENCE -> TEAM -> EVIDENCE -> PREFERENCES

Do not require a 45-minute wizard before showing value. Use completeness/readiness prompts such as: “Your profile is 62% ready. Adding previous projects will improve opportunity matching.”

Responsive strategy

Device	Primary experience
Desktop / laptop	Full discovery, document analysis, matrices, workspace coordination and response work.
Mobile	Discovery, alerts, summaries, task updates, quick review and deadline checking.

Accessibility

Target WCAG 2.2 AA: sufficient contrast, visible focus, keyboard operation, non-colour status indicators, accessible tables, readable type and clear errors.

Establish the shell and evidence experience without designing a fake tender MVP

Phase 0 implementation is foundation-focused, but its screens should establish a visual system that can later support discovery, matching, compliance and tender workspaces without redesigning the product shell.

Phase 0 screens to design at high fidelity

Screen / flow	Purpose
Authentication	WorkOS-integrated sign-in and authentication states.
Organization selector	Select or switch company context.
Application shell	Persistent navigation, utilities and responsive content frame.
Evidence library	List/search evidence and understand validity/status.
Upload evidence	Select → upload → validate/scan → available/quarantined.
Evidence detail	Metadata, trust, classification, version and authorized download.
Evidence version history	Show immutable previous versions and supersession.
Team members	Membership and coarse role management.
Invite member	Invitation workflow and role selection.
Organization settings	Basic tenant settings.
Audit activity	Material administrative/evidence activity.
System states	Empty, loading, failed, quarantined, restricted and offline/degraded states.

Document lifecycle vocabulary

UPLOADING → PROCESSING → SCANNING → AVAILABLE / REJECTED / QUARANTINED → SUPERSEDED → DELETED / SCHEDULED

Build reusable product language, not a collection of screens

The design system should make GovGazette recognizable through a small set of signature procurement components while providing a disciplined foundation for dense operational workflows.

Minimum component library

- Navigation, buttons, inputs, search, select/combobox and date controls.
- Tables, data lists, panels, tabs, filters, pagination and breadcrumbs.
- Notifications, dialogs, drawers, tooltips and dropdown menus.
- Upload controls, progress indicators, empty/error states and skeleton loaders.
- Avatars, user menu, organization selector and permission/restriction states.

Signature GovGazette components

Opportunity Card

Opportunity value, timing, fit, eligibility and primary action.

Evidence Citation

Source/version/location link for a material conclusion.

Requirement Card

Requirement, source, status, evidence, owner and review state.

Deadline Indicator

Urgency without alarm-heavy visual noise.

Tender Source Viewer

Original evidence with highlighted provenance.

Match Explanation

Fit factors, hard rules, strengths, weaknesses and next action.

Evidence Health

Validity, expiry and readiness at a glance.

Compliance Status

Consistent visual vocabulary for satisfied through failed.

Tender Workspace Header

Lifecycle, readiness, deadline and blocking risks.

AI Evidence Panel

Sources and trust controls behind AI-assisted output.

Interaction principle

Progressive disclosure: summary → explanation → detail → source. Action follows insight; preserve context; keep human control visible.

The engagement should produce both foundations and testable product journeys

High-fidelity screens alone are not enough. The designer should define the information architecture and reusable interaction language, then demonstrate that language through complete prototype flows.

Deliverable	Expected output
A. UX foundations	Sitemap · information architecture · personas · key journeys · navigation · workflow maps
B. Design system	Colour · typography · spacing · grids · icons · states · reusable components · interaction rules
C. Phase 0 high fidelity	Authentication · org selection · shell · evidence · team · settings · audit · system states
D. Future concepts	Discovery · opportunity detail · match · company profile · workspace · requirements · compliance · AI authoring

Prototype flows

Discover

Dashboard → recommendation → opportunity detail → match explanation → create pursuit.

Evidence

Evidence library → upload → processing → available → evidence details.

Tender execution

Workspace → requirement → source evidence → compliance gap → assign task → resolve.

Review

Response section → evidence → comments → approve / return for changes.

Success test

Within five minutes, a first-time user should answer

Where do I find opportunities? Which should we pursue? Why does GovGazette think we qualify? Where did a requirement come from? What are we missing? What closes soon? What should I do next?

Product promise

Don't find more tenders. Find the right tenders — and be ready to win them.